46. In an article for *Organiser* (25 June 1956), Golwalkar wrote that after SP Mookerjee resigned from the government, he did not find any of the existing parties suitable. He says they met often on his decision to form a new party. Recounted by K.S. Sudarshan, then joint general secretary, RSS (as told to Seshadri Chari), 'No ism but dharma', *Outlook,* 27 May 1998.
47. Mohan Bhagwat quoted in 'The Sangh as it is', *Organiser*, Vol. 70, N. 14, 30 September 2018, p 15.
48. Ibid.
49. Atal Bihari Vajpayee, L.K. Advani, Murali Manohar Joshi, Kushabhau Thakre, Bangaru Laxman, Jana Krishnamurthi, Rajnath Singh all started their careers initially with the RSS. Venkaiah Naidu also joined the RSS and started with ABVP, the RSS-affiliated student wing. Nitin Gadkari, considered close to RSS, and started his career with ABVP. Amit Shah joined the RSS as a student and then the ABVP. J.P. Nadda also started with the ABVP.
50. Interview with Ashwathnarayan C.N., deputy chief minister, Karnataka, Bengaluru, 10 February 2020. Also minister for higher education; IT & BT, science and technology; skill development, entrepreneurship and livelihood. Dr Ashwathnarayan lost his portfolio of deputy chief minister on 4 August 2021 when the BJP decided to do away with its three-deputy chief ministers formula in Karnataka after Basavaraj Bommai took as state chief minister, succeeding B.S. Yediyurappa.
51. Note on methodology: We looked for written evidence for the RSS/RSS-affiliate membership of BJP leaders on the lists we examined. Only if we could find such a reference, did we classify a minister as having an RSS/RSS-affiliate background. If we could not find a written reference, even in cases where we heard verbal references of a leader being 'close to the RSS' or other such allusions, as a thumb rule we chose to be cautious and did not classify the leader as being from RSS. So, the actual number of RSS/RSS-affiliate members may be higher. We followed this methodology for all the BJP lists we examined for RSS backgrounds.